How to Make Disciples

This section will explain the disciple-making process and share important concepts and ideas that will be needed later. Be sure to read it before using the logs and other pages later in this book.

Start with Prayer

When we spend time with Jesus in personal prayer and Bible study, love for Him springs up in the heart and motivates us to labor for the salvation of others (see Ps. 51:12, 13). Without Christ, we can do nothing (see John 15:5). For this reason: "Nothing is more needed in our work than the practical results of communion with God. . . . This will impart to the worker a power that nothing else can give" (*Gospel Workers*, p. 510). Making disciples, and helping others to grow spiritually, is a supernatural work. It is "God who gives the increase" (1 Cor. 3:7). Therefore, praying for the Holy Spirit to influence people's hearts is essential. "Through much prayer you must labor for souls" (*Evangelism*, p. 342).

Follow Christ's Method

Isaiah compared the growth of righteousness to a budding plant springing forth from a seed sown in a garden (see Isa. 61:11). Similarly, Jesus and Paul likened Christ's method of making disciples to the agricultural growth cycle (see Matt. 9:37, 38; Luke 8:11; 10:2; 1 Cor. 3:6; 2 Cor. 9:6). This biblical analogy can be used to describe five essential phases of disciple-making: **prepare** the soil of the heart, **plant** seeds of truth, **cultivate** spiritual interest, **harvest** decisions for Christ, and **preserve** the harvest.